THE LANGUAGE LAB

# English Level Placement Test

CEFR Levels A1 and A2

| Skills assessed | Total time | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| Reading · Writing · Speaking | Approximately 55–65 minutes | Place candidates at A1 or A2 |

## Candidate Information

| | |
|---|---|
| **Full name:** | _____ |
| **Date of birth:** | _____ Date of test: _____ |
| **Candidate ID (if any):** | _____ Examiner: _____ |
| **Native language:** | _____ Centre: _____ |

## Overview of the Test

| Part | Skill | Tasks | Time | Marks |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Reading | 20 questions (vocabulary, grammar, texts) | 25 min | 40 |
| 2 | Writing | 2 tasks (personal form + short paragraph) | 20 min | 20 |
| 3 | Speaking | 3 stages (interview, description, dialogue) | 8–10 min | 20 |
| | | **Total** | ≈ **55–65 min** | **80** |

## General Instructions for Candidates

1. Write all answers in **English** using a blue or black pen.
2. Do **not** use a dictionary, phone, or translation tool.
3. For multiple-choice questions, circle **one** letter only (A, B, C, or D).
4. If you change an answer, cross out the old one clearly and circle the new one.
5. Manage your time: leave a few minutes to check Part 1 and Part 2.
6. In the Speaking test, listen carefully and answer in full sentences when you can.
7. There is no negative marking. Attempt every question.

**Level decision:** Scores place you at **Below A1**, **A1**, or **A2**. This test is designed for beginner and elementary placement only. It does not certify B1 or higher.

# PART 1 — READING · 25 minutes · 40 marks

*Answer all questions. Each question is worth **2 marks** unless stated otherwise.*

## Section A — Everyday English (Questions 1–8)

*Choose the best word or phrase to complete each sentence. Circle A, B, C, or D.*

1. My name _____ Anna. I am from Poland.
   A) am B) is C) are D) be
2. _____ is your phone number?
   A) Who B) Where C) What D) When
3. I usually _____ coffee in the morning.
   A) drink B) drinks C) drinking D) to drink
4. There _____ two books on the table.
   A) is B) are C) be D) am
5. Excuse me, _____ is the train station?
   A) who B) what C) where D) how
6. She _____ to work by bus every day.
   A) go B) goes C) going D) gone
7. Can you _____ the window, please? It is hot in here.
   A) open B) opens C) opening D) opened
8. I _____ to the cinema yesterday.
   A) go B) goes C) went D) going

## Section B — Vocabulary (Questions 9–12)

*Choose the word that best completes each sentence. Circle A, B, C, or D.*

9. I need to buy bread, milk, and eggs. I am going to the _____.
   A) hospital B) supermarket C) cinema D) station
10. My brother is a _____. He works in a school.
    A) teacher B) driver C) waiter D) pilot
11. It is very _____ outside. Please take an umbrella.
    A) sunny B) windy C) rainy D) snowy
12. We live in a small _____ near the park.
    A) apple B) apartment C) animal D) answer

## Section C — Notices and Signs (Questions 13–16)

*Match each notice (13–16) with the correct meaning (A–E). There is one extra meaning you do not need. Write the letter in the box.*

| Notices | Meanings |
|---|---|
| 13. PLEASE DO NOT FEED THE ANIMALS<br>14. STAFF ONLY<br>15. NO PARKING<br>16. QUIET PLEASE — EXAM IN PROGRESS | A. You must not leave your car here.<br>B. Only workers can enter this area.<br>C. Do not give food to the animals.<br>D. Speak softly; people are taking a test.<br>E. Buy your tickets before 6 p.m. |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 13 → ____ | 14 → ____ | 15 → ____ | 16 → ____ |

# PART 1 — READING (continued)

## Section D — Short Message (Questions 17–18)

*Read the message. Then answer the questions.*

**Hi Sara,**
Would you like to come to my house on Saturday? We can watch a film and have pizza. Please arrive at 6 o'clock. My address is 14 Green Street, near the big supermarket. Call me if you cannot come.
Love, Maya

17. What does Maya want to do on Saturday?
    A) Go shopping with Sara
    B) Watch a film and eat pizza at home
    C) Visit the supermarket
    D) Call Sara at 6 o'clock

18. Where does Maya live?
    A) Near a cinema
    B) At Sara's house
    C) At 14 Green Street
    D) Next to a school

## Section E — Reading Text (Questions 19–20)

*Read the text. Then answer the questions.*

**A Day in My Life**

My name is Tom. I am 28 and I live in Manchester with my wife, Lisa. I work in a bookshop in the city centre from nine to five. I like my job because I love books and I meet interesting people. In the evening we often cook together. On Fridays we sometimes go to a restaurant. At the weekend I play football with friends; Lisa prefers to stay at home and read. Next month we want to visit London for three days. We are both excited about the trip.

19. Why does Tom like his job?
    A) Because he finishes work early
    B) Because he loves books and meets interesting people
    C) Because the bookshop is near his house
    D) Because Lisa works with him

20. What do Tom and Lisa want to do next month?
    A) Play football in the park
    B) Open a restaurant
    C) Visit London for three days
    D) Move to Manchester

**End of Part 1.** Check your answers. Then go on to Part 2 — Writing.

# PART 2 — WRITING · 20 minutes · 20 marks

*Complete both tasks. Write clearly. Spelling and grammar are part of the mark.*

## Task 1 — Personal Information Form (8 marks)

*Complete the form about yourself. Write short answers in English. Use full words (not only numbers) where possible.*

| Question | Your answer |
|---|---|
| 1. What is your full name? | |
| 2. How old are you? | |
| 3. Where do you live? (city / country) | |
| 4. What is your job or what do you study? | |
| 5. What languages do you speak? | |
| 6. What do you like doing in your free time? | |
| 7. Why are you learning English? | |
| 8. Write one sentence about your family. | |

## Task 2 — Short Paragraph (12 marks)

*Write **40–60 words** about your typical day. Include information about:*

- when you get up
- what you do in the morning
- what you do in the afternoon or evening
- something you like about your day

*Write your paragraph below. Count your words at the end.*

Word count: _____ Examiner use only — Task 1: ____ / 8 Task 2: ____ / 12 Total Writing: ____ / 20

**Tips:** Use present simple for routines (I get up, I go, I eat). Use capital letters and full stops. Check subject–verb agreement (he/she + -s).

# PART 3 — SPEAKING · 8–10 minutes · 20 marks

*This part is a face-to-face interview with an examiner. You may look at the picture prompt when the examiner shows it. Speak clearly. It is better to give a short answer than to say nothing.*

## What will happen

| Stage | Focus | Time | What you do |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Personal interview | 3 min | Answer questions about yourself, home, work/study, free time. |
| 2 | Picture description | 3 min | Describe a picture. Say who/what you see and what people are doing. |
| 3 | Short dialogue | 2–4 min | Ask and answer simple questions on an everyday topic. |

## Useful language you may use

• My name is … / I live in … / I work as … / I am a student.
• In my free time I … / I like … because …
• In the picture I can see … / There is / There are … / He is …-ing.
• Could you repeat that, please? / Sorry, I do not understand.
• What about you? / Do you …? / Where do you …?

## Picture prompt (Stage 2) — Candidate view

*The examiner will show you a picture similar to the description below. Practise describing scenes like this.*

**Scene description (for reference / practice)**

A café on a sunny day. Two people are sitting at a table outside. A woman is drinking coffee. A man is reading a newspaper. A waiter is carrying a tray with sandwiches. A child is playing with a dog near a tree. There are flowers on the table and bicycles in front of the café.

## Candidate self-check (optional, before the interview)

■ I can say my name, age, and where I live.
■ I can talk about my job or studies in simple sentences.
■ I can say what I like doing in my free time.
■ I can describe people and actions in a picture (There is… / He is …-ing).
■ I can ask simple questions (Do you…? / Where…? / What…?).

**End of the candidate paper.** Please wait for the examiner for Part 3 — Speaking. Do not write on the Examiner Pack pages.

# EXAMINER PACK — CONFIDENTIAL

*Do not give these pages to candidates. Use them for administration, scoring, and the speaking interview.*

## Answer Key — Part 1 Reading (40 marks)

*Award **2 marks** for each correct answer.*

| Q | Answer | Q | Answer | Q | Answer | Q | Answer |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | B (is) | 6 | B (goes) | 11 | C (rainy) | 16 | D |
| 2 | C (What) | 7 | A (open) | 12 | B (apartment) | 17 | B |
| 3 | A (drink) | 8 | C (went) | 13 | C | 18 | C |
| 4 | B (are) | 9 | B (supermarket) | 14 | B | 19 | B |
| 5 | C (where) | 10 | A (teacher) | 15 | A | 20 | C |

Extra meaning in Section C (not used): **E**.

## Writing Mark Scheme — Part 2 (20 marks)

### Task 1 — Form (8 marks)

Award **1 mark** per item if the answer is understandable and relevant in English. Accept minor spelling errors if meaning is clear. Award 0 if blank, in another language only, or completely off-topic. Maximum: 8.

### Task 2 — Paragraph (12 marks)

| Band | Marks | Descriptor |
|---|---|---|
| Strong A2 | 10–12 | Clear routine description; mostly accurate present simple; linked ideas; 40+ words; message fully achieved. |
| A2 | 7–9 | Adequate description; some errors but meaning usually clear; mostly on topic; about 40 words. |
| A1 | 4–6 | Simple sentences or phrases; limited control of present simple; meaning partly clear; may be short. |
| Below A1 | 1–3 | Very little English; isolated words; message hard to follow. |
| No attempt | 0 | Blank or not in English. |

# SPEAKING — EXAMINER SCRIPT · 20 marks

*Conduct the interview in a friendly, supportive way. Allow brief thinking time. You may rephrase a question once. Do not teach during the test.*

## Stage 1 — Personal interview (about 3 minutes)

**Examiner says:**

"Hello. My name is _____. What's your name?"
"Nice to meet you. How are you today?"
"Where do you live?" / "Who do you live with?"
"Do you work or are you a student?" → follow up: "What do you do?" / "What do you study?"
"What do you like doing in your free time?"
"Tell me about a typical day in your week."

*Prompt if needed: "What time do you get up?" "What do you eat for breakfast?" "When do you finish work/school?"*

## Stage 2 — Picture description (about 3 minutes)

**Examiner says:** "Look at this picture of a café. Tell me what you can see."

*If the candidate is silent after 10–15 seconds, ask support questions:*

- How many people are there?
- What is the woman doing?
- What is the man doing?
- What is the waiter carrying?
- Is it a sunny day or a rainy day?
- Would you like to go to this café? Why / Why not?

## Stage 3 — Short dialogue (2–4 minutes)

**Topic card — Food and meals (give orally; do not require reading)**

**Examiner says:** "Let's talk about food. I will ask you some questions, and then you ask me two questions."

**Ask the candidate:**

- What do you usually eat for breakfast?
- What is your favourite meal?
- Do you like cooking? Why / Why not?
- Where do you usually have lunch?

**Then say:** "Now please ask me two questions about food or meals."

*Accept any relevant questions (e.g. "Do you like pizza?" "What do you eat for dinner?"). Answer briefly and naturally.*

## Speaking Mark Scheme (20 marks)

| Criterion | Marks | A1 indicators | A2 indicators |
|---|---|---|---|
| Interaction & fluency | 0–5 | Short answers; long pauses; needs heavy support | Keeps going with short turns; occasional hesitation |
| Vocabulary | 0–5 | Basic personal words only | Everyday vocabulary for home, work, free time, food |
| Grammar | 0–5 | Isolated phrases; little sentence control | Simple present / present continuous with frequent but clear errors |
| Pronunciation & task success | 0–5 | Hard to follow; task only partly done | Mostly intelligible; describes picture and asks simple questions |

Total Speaking = sum of four criteria (maximum 20). Half marks are allowed (e.g. 3.5) if your local policy permits; otherwise round to the nearest whole mark.

# SCORE SHEET & LEVEL DECISION

| | |
|---|---|
| **Candidate name:** | _____ |
| **Examiner name:** | _____ Date: _____ |

| Component | Raw score | Maximum |
|---|---|---|
| Part 1 Reading | _____ | 40 |
| Part 2 Writing | _____ | 20 |
| Part 3 Speaking | _____ | 20 |
| **TOTAL** | _____ | **80** |

## Official level placement (total out of 80)

| Total score | Placement | Typical profile |
|---|---|---|
| 0–24 | Below A1 | Needs pre-A1 / absolute beginner support before an A1 course. |
| 25–49 | A1 | Can handle basic personal information with support; limited connected text. |
| 50–80 | A2 | Can manage simple everyday reading, short writing, and basic spoken interaction. |

## Borderline cases (optional examiner judgement)

If the total is within **3 marks** of a boundary (22–27 or 47–52), review skill balance. Place at the **higher** level only if at least two skills clearly match it; if one skill is much weaker (e.g. Speaking ≤ 6/20), prefer the **lower** level.

## Final placement

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ■ Below A1 | ■ A1 | ■ A2 |

## Examiner comments / recommended next steps

Examiner signature: _____ Date: _____

**CEFR alignment note.** This test samples A1–A2 can-do statements for short texts, basic personal writing, and simple spoken interaction. It is a placement tool, not an official CEFR certificate.